



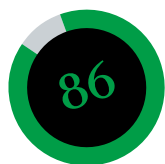
Facebook News, Soon?

Facebook, is reportedly working on a news app which will offer you on-the-go news content. Read more here: <http://dgit.in/fbnewssoon>

The future of 3D is here!

Finally a display which can give us 3D pictures without having to wear specialised 3D glasses! <http://dgit.in/new3ddsply>

Bazaar



Features 91
Build 80

Specifications

Chipset: Intel Z170;
Memory support: 4x3866(OC)MHz upto 64GB; **LAN:** Intel + Killer E2400 Gigabit Ethernet; **Audio:** Creative Sound Core 3D; **SATA:** 8x SATA III; **Expansion:** 3x PCIe x16(x16+x8+x4); **Dimensions (LxWxD):** 305 mm x 244 mm; **Warranty:** 3 years

Contact

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Gigabyte GA-Z170X Gaming 7

One of the best Z170 boards you can get

Among Gigabyte's arsenal of Z170 motherboards, there are very few that can match the feature set that the GA-Z170X Gaming 7 sports. Gigabyte has gone all out to up the ante on build quality with metal shielding on all PCIe x16 slots which helps with the more heavy graphics cards that are becoming more and more mainstream. Then comes the rigid housing protecting the rear I/O connectors. Speaking of which, most of the sockets in the rear I/O panel happen to be gold plated which helps avoid corrosion.

The GA-Z170X Gaming 7 features the latest Killer E2400 Ethernet chip along with an Intel GbE. It also features Intel's USB 3.1 controller through which you get one Type A connector and a



Price
₹22,000

Type C connector. With a Creative Sound Core 3D CODEC and the ability to swap out OP-AMPs, the user not only gets a better audio capabilities but can also customise the sound signature to his/her liking.

If you haven't been keeping up with the advances in the storage segment then NVMe M.2 SSDs have finally arrived and this board has two M.2

connectors, both of which use x4 PCIe lanes allowing for throughput of 32Gbps. What's even better is that you can configure RAID on these slots, giving you speeds you could only have dreamed of till now.

The GA-Z170X-Gaming 7 may be a bit on the pricier side of Z170 boards but it justifies the price with great build quality and a bountiful feature set.

Mithun Mobandas

Leadtek Quadro K420

Optimal for very specific scenarios

While workstation cards might not be something you'd have expected to see on one of these pages but there's a first time for everything. NVIDIA's

QUADRO K420 happens to be a very economical workstation card for some very specific applications. While improved drivers and the Maxwell architecture has narrowed down the gap between workstation and gaming graphics cards there are still certain applications that fare well only on these.

The advantage that these QUADRO cards have over GTX cards are that more attention is paid towards the drivers with multiple versions being released that are certified to function optimally with CAD software. The underlying GPU in the K420 is the GK107 which is the same as the GTX 630 (2012) but the K420 is clocked at a

significantly higher speed giving it a much higher single precision and double precision throughput. We took something recent, i.e. the GTX 750 Ti and compared it to the K420 since they're both in the same price segment. We found that the

GTX 750 Ti had a clear advantage in most industrial CAD benchmarks except for a few like Siemen's NX and PTC's Creo 2.0.

We are more curious to see how the K620 would perform in a similar situation since it's more recent and runs on the same GM107 GPU that the GTX 750 Ti does.

With the K420, it would be advisable to figure out which CAD application you wish to run primarily before deciding between a gaming graphics card or a workstation card based on the same architecture.



Price
₹13,500



Performance..... 64
Value 60
Build 60

Specifications

Chipset: GK107; **Base clock:** 876 MHz; **Memory clock:** 891 MHz; **Stream processors:** 192; **Texture Units:** 16; **ROPs:** 16; **Single Precision:** 299.52 GFLOPS; **Double Precision:** 12.48 GFLOPS; **Memory:** 1 GB; **DirectX support:** 11.2; **OpenGL support:** 4.5; **Power Connectors:** None; **TDP:** 41 W; **Warranty:** 3 years

Contact

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